



NESLOKE-*Lite*

Player's Guide

A free introduction to the tabletop role-playing game

by KevTyler



® YOUR JOURNEY BEGINS WITHIN NESLOKE

The land of Nesloke exists within the great water wall. This is a continent made up of six nations, sometimes allies, sometimes enemies. Few people remember the early days of the wars, but many wars have been waging for a long time.

It is here within Nesloke that you get to experience a world with castles, armored knights, trebuchets, and battalions, while also experiencing enhancements in war and culture due to the availability of magic. This is no ordinary kings and castles setting. This is a setting where magic has been around for millennia, and because of that, the natural scientific advancements we would see in the real world are replaced in some aspects with magical enhancements.

Binders and builders have come together to create items such as speaking stones, enchanted items that allow you to speak with someone across the continent. Additionally, casters have worked with in-world engineer-minded people, creating versions of vehicles that, without the magic from a caster, would otherwise not exist.

And that ultimately is the crux of this world: a world filled with magic, but not full of magic. You see, only one in 500 are ever born with these Potezen powers, these magical powers. Of those that have the power, so few go beyond just tiny abilities that the majority of people will live their entire life never knowingly interacting with a Potezen individual.

And when you enter the world, if you want to be one of these Potezen, you can choose from seven archetypes: the Mover, who has telekinesis, the Deceiver, who deceives what you see by manipulating perceptions, the Reader, who will read your mind, the Teller, who will read the future, the Caster, who uses elements both to attack and fight as well as to defend, the Builder, who can manipulate material, allowing things to be built seemingly out of nothing, and the Binder, who can enchant those very same objects

But when you are entering this world, you are not limited to choosing someone who has powers. There are also five archetypes that exist from sheer will, skill, and determination: the Warrior, the Hunter, the Scoundrel, the Troubadour, and the Apothecary

These are ultimately the available archetypes within the world of Nesloke, but here in this initial journey, you will be introduced to five of them.



WHAT NESLOKE-LITE IS

Nesloke-Lite is not just an allusion to the game, or a dumbed-down version. This is a complete, playable slice of the full game. Absolutely everything a group will need to make characters and to play through levels one through three.

What's available within this Lite version of the game:

- Five of the 12 archetypes
- All of the skills for each archetype from level one to level three
- The entire core system, all set within both a player's guide and a GM's guide
- A mini campaign set within the land of Giljair, so that you have an opportunity to play the game, see if you like it, and feel immersed in the world

Here's what the full game adds:

- All twelve archetypes with the leveling-up skills all the way to level twelve
- Crafting
- Subsystems
- More information on armor and weapons
- Deeper looks into the lore and world of Nesloke

If you enjoy Nesloke-Lite, I encourage you to head to my Kickstarter page, where the Kickstarter will be available in Fall 2026.

BOOK STRUCTURE

- **This Player's Guide:** everything you read to make a character and play: the core system, combat, the five archetypes, character creation, and how you grow.
- **The GM's Guide (companion book):** everything your Game Master uses to run the game, including the mini-campaign.

READING THE RULES

- Bold text marks a rule term or system feature.
- Italics carry narrative or descriptive language.
- Key abbreviations are always capitalized: DA (Difficulty Aim / Defensive Armor), FP (Fatigue Points), WP (Wound Points).

AT THE TABLE

Nesloke doesn't use traditional ttrpg maps or encounters based on movement or distance. Instead, player imagination and clear description set the scenes of both battle and roleplay. No visual aids are required for game mechanics, though GMs can always choose to provide images for cinematic clarity and flair.

WHAT IS A TABLETOP ROLE-PLAYING GAME (TTRPG)?

A TTRPG is collaborative storytelling with systematic rules to guide the game and create everything from tension to humor. The Game Master (GM) presents a world, the people who exist within the world, and the consequences of players' successes and failures. Players use their created player-characters who live within that created world. The rules exist as guidelines of how the GM and Players can both interact within the world in a fair and structured way.

THE NATURE OF PLAY

Play begins with the GM setting the stage and describing the immediate scene. A player, through clear description of action, roleplay, or a combination, advises what their player-character does within that scene. Whether in combat or roleplay, if the action taken does not have a guaranteed outcome, decided by the GM, they can call for a check. The player rolls a d12 against a Difficulty Aim (for Roleplay) or Defensive Armor (for combat) (DA). The roll defines success or failure, and the story adjusts. You describe your intent, the dice decide the outcome, and the story progresses based on this. Success may feel like a victory, and failure may feel like defeat, but both move the story forward and work in continuing to create the overall collaborative story set forth at the onset.

THE FLOW OF PLAY

Every session moves through the same sequence: the GM establishes setting and conflict, players describe what they attempt, the GM calls for checks when outcomes are uncertain, players may spend tokens on skill or to shape results, the GM narrates the outcome and applies FP or WP effects, and the story moves on. This generalized flow is consistent across each in-game encounter.

What You Need to Play 1 Game Master, 2 to 6 players, one or more twelve-sided dice, character sheets, tokens, and writing tools to track FP, WP, and resources (all of these can be physical or digital).

The Nesloke Basics

The whole game in two pages. This is your high-level road map. Everything beyond are the intricate details.

If you want to hit the ground running, and leave all the specific details of how to play to your GM, these Nesloke Basics, along with your character sheet, is all you will need.

THE ONE ROLL

The roll in one line 1d12 + Attribute + Tokens (max 3, +1 each) vs. DA

When you attempt something uncertain, you make a Check. Roll a d12, add the applicable Attribute bonus, add any Tokens you spend. If the total meets or beats the Difficulty Aim (DA), you succeed. If an action has no real chance of failure, the GM doesn't call for a roll at all.

THE SEVEN ATTRIBUTES

Every Check draws on one of seven attributes: STR (strength), DEX (dexterity), END (endurance), INT (intellect), WIS (wisdom), CHA (charisma), and WIL (willpower). Your archetype shapes which ones you lean on.

YOUR THREE RESOURCES

- **Tokens:** your central resource. Spend them to initiate or activate skills AND/OR to add up to an additional +3 to a roll (spending 1 token per +1). At level 1 after every long rest you have 12.

- **FP (Fatigue Points):** stamina and composure. Most hits drain FP first.
- **WP (Wound Points):** physical durability and actual damage. When FP hits 0 further damage may cut into WP (details in GM guide). WP can also be drained by critical hits or certain skills.

OUTCOMES AREN'T JUST PASS OR FAIL

The margin between your roll and the DA sets how well or badly it goes, from a Critical Failure (an intentionally rare thing within this game) that worsens the situation, through Partial and clean Success, up to a Critical Success that earns something extra. Combat uses the same idea to set how hard a hit lands.

THE SHAPE OF A TURN

Combat has no initiative order and no measured movement. Two sides alternate: the active side acts, then the other responds. On your side's turn each player-character can take one Core Action, one Minor Action, and two Reactions. These do not have to be done one player at a time, the player-characters can act off of each other or back and forth within one turn. Distance is described in plain language as Close (most combat) Far, and In the Distance (too far to fight), not squares.

N CORE MECHANICS

This chapter explains how play functions at the table. This includes how actions are declared, rolls are made, and how to understand the mechanical influence of Tokens and attributes. Whether you are negotiating, climbing, or fighting, the same pattern applies.

THE STANDARD ROLL

The roll in one line 1d12 + Attribute + Beyond Skill Tokens (max 3, +1 each) vs. DA

When a player attempts any uncertain action, they make a Check. If the total meets or exceeds the Difficulty Aim (DA), the action succeeds. Rolls exist when a given outcome is not guaranteed. If an action in roleplay can only succeed as a clean success or higher, the GM should not call for a Check. Attack rolls specifically use 1d12 + Attribute only, plus any Tokens spent; flat numeric bonuses are reserved for individual archetype skills.

Component	Details
Attribute Bonus	From the relevant attribute (STR, DEX, END, INT, WIS, CHA, or WIL).
Tokens Spent (not including token cost for	Each Token adds +1 to the result. Maximum 3 Tokens per roll. Declared before rolling.

Component	Details
skills)	
DA	The target number set by the GM, or fixed by the skill, for the task.

OUTCOME TIERS

Results are never binary. The margin between the roll and the DA determines what happens. There are separate tier sets for roleplay/skill checks and for combat.

ROLEPLAY AND SKILL CHECKS

Outcome	Roll vs. DA	Effect
Critical Failure	-8 or worse	Significant complication or extreme backlash; -4 FP to the acting player. The situation meaningfully worsens.
Failure	-3 to -7 below DA	The attempt fails; -2 FP to the acting player.
Partial Success	-1 to -2 below DA	Minimum success; intent barely achieved, -1 FP from the effort.
Success	0 to +5 above DA	Standard clean result; intent achieved with no extra cost.
Critical Success	+6 or more above DA	Extraordinary outcome; additional narrative benefit gained.

Critical Success triggers at +6 or more above DA; Critical Failure at -8 or worse below DA. The -8 floor is deliberate: on a standard DA it can only be reached through Strain or a negative attribute modifier, which keeps extreme backlash rare.

TOKENS

Tokens are the game's central resource and narrative lever. Every character at level one begins after a long rest with 12 Tokens and gains +2 to their maximum pool per level. Tokens have exactly two uses.

Use	Cost	Effect
Boost a Roll	1 to 3 Tokens	Each Token adds +1 to the result. Maximum 3 per roll. Declared before rolling.
Activate a Skill	Varies	Pays the activation cost listed on the skill entry.

Outside of activating a skill, Tokens only add +1 each (maximum 3 per roll). They are declared before the roll; there are no post-roll spends unless a specific skill allows it, and no rerolls by default.

EDGE AND STRAIN

Modifier	Effect	Stacking
Edge	+2 to a roll when circumstances clearly favor the character.	Does not stack with other Edge opportunities.. Maximum +2 regardless of how many sources grant Edge to the player-character.
Strain	-2 to a roll when the character is at a disadvantage.	Stacks up to 3 times. Maximum penalty -6 on a single roll.

Though Edge does not stack with itself, token bonuses and skill based modifiers outside of skills that grant Edge can stack on top of Edge.

GROUP AND COOPERATIVE CHECKS

When multiple players work together, the GM may call for a Group Check: each player rolls, and if at least half succeed, the group achieves the goal. For direct cooperation, one player rolls while another uses the universal Help Ally action to grant Edge. If done correctly, every check will advance or change the scene. This applies whether the check is passed or failed.

FATIGUE, WOUNDS, AND THE 0 FP RULE

FP (Fatigue Points) measures stamina and composure; WP measures physical durability and damage. Regular hits remove FP first. When FP reaches 0, the character acts with Strain on all checks, and any further FP damage may subtract from WP (details in GM guide). For each turn a character remains at 0 FP, they gain 1 stack of Strain, to a maximum of 3 stacks (-6). When WP reaches 0, the character is incapacitated and near death. When FP rises above 0, 1 Strain from exhaustion clears, per turn until all Strain is cleared, unless a skill states otherwise.

COMBAT AND RESOLUTION

Combat within Nesloke is designed intentionally to progress quickly and efficiently without taking away from the narrative and tension of combat. There is no initiative or measured movement. Every attack regardless of archetype or skill uses the same core pattern: 1d12 + Attribute + Tokens vs. DA. A hit is a success against the target's Defensive Armor (DA).

In addition to the intentionally simplified combat rolls, the removal of initiative is there so that the players can act almost simultaneously to better emulate the fact that in real combat no one waits for their turn.

GROUP TURN SYSTEM

Combat alternates between two sides, your allies and your enemies. The active side acts (each member performs their available actions), then the opposing side acts in response,

and this repeats until resolution. Within a side's turn, players are not bound by an initiative order. Instead, they have the ability to act when they would like and based directly off of their allies' actions in a collaborative way. An example of this is Player A may use their Core Action, then Player B uses their Minor Action. This is followed by Player A deciding they now want to use their Minor Action, and Player B then uses their Core action. Both players ultimately used both their Core and Minor Action, but they were not bound to do so in a specific order. Each combat round (both Ally and Enemy turns) is exactly five seconds of story time.

ACTIONS PER TURN

Action Type	Per Turn	Description
Core Action	1	Major effort: attacks, spells, or powerful skill activations.
Minor Action	1	Supportive or preparatory: aiding an ally, quick support, sustaining a state.
Reaction	2 (per round)	Triggered often off-turn by a defined condition (a miss, an incoming hit, an ally faltering).
Incidental	As reasonable	Reflexive or minimal: short speech, dropping an item, a quick glance. GM-bounded.

ATTACK RESOLUTION

Attack 1d12 + Attribute + Tokens (max 3, +1 each) vs. DA

- Melee uses STR unless the weapon or skill says otherwise.
- Ranged (Far) uses DEX unless the weapon or skill says otherwise.
- Bonus Tokens are spent before the roll, each adding +1, to a maximum of 3.

HIT SEVERITY

The margin of the attack roll over the target's DA sets hit severity. Both sides can pay on a poorly committed swing.

Hit Type	Margin vs. DA	FP/WP Effect
Critical Miss	-8 or more below DA	Attacker -4 FP and GM decided negative consequences. Fails to hit target.
Entire Miss	-3 to -7 below DA	Attacker -2 FP, Fails to hit target.
Partial Hit	-2 to -1 below DA	Target -1 FP; Attacker -1 FP (overextension). Both sides pay.
Grazing Hit	0 to +1 above DA	Target -2 FP. A real but minor strike.
Direct Hit	+2 to +5 above DA	Target -4 FP. A solid, clean strike.
Critical Hit	+6 or more above DA	Target -6 FP and -1 WP. Devastating: fatigue and a wound.

When FP reaches 0, further FP damage may subtract from WP instead. A Critical Hit should always feel threatening but will not one-shot a character unless already injured.

STRAIN IN COMBAT

- At 0 FP, gain 1 stack of Strain (-2 on all checks).
- Each turn spent at 0 FP adds a Strain stack, to a maximum of 3 (-6 on all checks).
- When FP rises above 0, 1 Strain from exhaustion clears, per turn until all Strain is cleared, unless a skill states otherwise.

COVER, HIGH GROUND, AND POSITION

There is no measured movement, and the following is at the GMs discretion. Use plain language for position. While in cover, DA is increased by +2, lost when cover is broken. Far attacks from a clearly higher position with a Far-based weapon gain Edge. If line of sight is unclear, the GM applies Strain to the attacker or raises DA as fits the fiction.

DEFENSIVE ARMOR

Defensive Armor (DA) DA = Base archetype DA + Gear Bonuses

DA is what attackers must beat to land a hit; the margin over DA sets severity. Each archetype page lists its base DA.

DISTANCE

Distance is handled as three broad, per-target states managed narratively, never in feet or grid squares.

State	Meaning
Close	Melee and immediate reach. Ranged weapons function here with no disadvantage.
Far	A meaningful gap; the standard ranged band.
In the Distance	Very far; reachable only by specific skills, such as a Hunter's Long Shot.

Universal Actions

Some things every character can do, no matter who they are or what they have learned. These are the baseline moves of Nesloke: the punch anyone can throw, the ally anyone can steady, the danger anyone can try to slip. They cost no Tokens. They ask only an action and, sometimes, a roll. Everything your archetype and your purchased skills can do is built on top of these.

Grappling

When you take hold of a target with Simple Grapple, they are grappled. While grappled, a creature's Core Action must be spent trying to break free, unless the action they want to take requires no physical

movement. To break free, roll 1d12 + STR vs DA 8 plus the grappler's STR. Some skills change how you escape or what a grapple does to you.

Core Actions

Each takes your Core Action for the turn.

Basic Strike

Attribute: STR (melee) / DEX (ranged) • Roll: vs Target's DA

Attack a target at Close or Far range. The plain swing or the loosed shot, the thing anyone can do when it comes to a fight. Melee uses STR; a ranged attack uses DEX.

Simple Grapple

Attribute: STR • Roll: vs Target's DA

Take hold of a target to restrain or subdue them. You seize and hold, trying to control where they are and what they can do. What happens while they are held, and how they break free, follows the grapple rules.

Help Ally

Attribute: CHA • Roll: None

Give one ally Edge on their next action for one turn. A word, a distraction, a hand at the right moment, you make what they are about to do a little easier.

Push/Pull

Attribute: STR • Roll: vs Target's DA

Forcefully move a target or object. Shove them back, drag it aside, put something where it needs to be through plain strength.

Charm

Attribute: CHA • Roll: GM-set DA

Try to warm an NPC toward you. Not magic, just presence and words, an attempt to move someone's disposition in your favor. The GM sets the difficulty by who they are and how they already feel.

Recall

Attribute: INT • Roll: GM-set DA

Draw on what you know to identify, assess, or understand something in the scene. You reach into memory and training for the fact that helps right now.

Minor Actions

Each takes your Minor Action for the turn.

Observe Surroundings

Attribute: WIS • Roll: GM-set DA

Scan for threats, clues, or details. You take a moment to really look, and the scene gives up what a careless glance would miss.

Forage Basics

Attribute: WIS • Roll: GM-set DA

Find food, water, or basic materials. The knowledge of what the land offers and where to look for it.

Pathfinding

Attribute: END • Roll: GM-set DA

Navigate terrain or find a safe route. You read the ground ahead and choose the way through.

Sense Motive

Attribute: WIL • Roll: GM-set DA

Read a person for falsehood or hidden intent. You watch for the tell, the thing that does not match the words.

Reactions

Triggered off your turn, when the moment calls for it.

Brace

Attribute: END • Roll: 1d12 + END vs DA 10

When you are about to take damage, steel yourself against it. On a success, reduce the incoming FP loss by 1. On a failure, take the normal FP loss plus 1 more. On a Critical Failure, take the normal loss plus additional FP at the GM's discretion. You set your feet and take the hit rather than hope to avoid it.

Quick Dodge

Attribute: DEX • Roll: 1d12 + DEX vs DA 12

When an attack or hazard comes at you, throw yourself clear. On a success, you avoid the hit entirely. On a failure, take the normal FP loss plus 1 more. On a Critical Failure, take the normal loss plus additional FP at the GM's discretion. Harder to pull off than a Brace, but when it works, nothing touches you.

Ⓝ THE FIVE ARCHETYPES

Within Nesloke-Lite, these are the 5 Archetypes available. Each archetype opens with a character description, general mechanics, and a preview of level-one skills. Read all five before you build your character or choose to use a pre-generated character

ROSTER AT A GLANCE

Three Potezen (the magic-born) and two non-Potezen (experts in their field who do not have magic).

Archetype	Potezen?	Primary Abilities	Primary Attribute
Caster	Yes	Elemental creation, attacks, and defense	DEX
Mover	Yes	Telekinesis	WIL
Deceiver	Yes	Perception and Sensory Manipulation	WIL
Hunter	No	Ranged fighter and tracker	DEX
Apothecary	No	Healer and alchemist	WIS

CASTER

Potezen (Magic-Born): *The elemental heart. Magic you can see, feel, and hide behind.*

Within the world of Nesloke, it is the casters who are often seen as the Potezen fighters. They are the ones who, through sheer magical ability, are able to manipulate the elements around them in order to fight for what they want or defend those they care about.

They are the typical raw elemental magic fantasy user, casting fire or ice, using the dirt around them or the mud or the water. As they grow stronger, they are able to generate these elements out of nothing.

And two casters do not have to be the same. A unique aspect of being a caster is choosing a focused element. You can choose to be fire-based, or water-based, or earth-based, or ice-based. You can choose to harness electricity, or manipulate air.

And just because you can wield these elements does not mean you have to be offensive. You can choose to use them in a support function, be defensive or supportive, or lean heavily into the classic attacks.

While the caster may appear frail in their wound points and available fatigue points, it is through their magic that they so often hold the advantage in a fight. It is through their magic that they sway the tide of war. It is because of their ability that, no matter what army you are in within Nesloke, as a caster, you are admired and sought after and treated often better than generals.

The caster works to become an expert in their chosen element. And in doing this, when a caster enters the story, they are all but expected to change the way things are played.

Who will love this: the player who wants unmistakable magic. The one who wants to wield the powers and wonders of the elements around them. Whether they want to be a fighter, or just support, the Caster can cover both angles.

Role at the table: elemental offense and support. The party's magical answer to problems.

Mechanical Identity

- **Type:** A Potezen who produces and projects the elements, with element choice driving how they play.
 - The Caster must choose their primary element (available via Conjure) at time of creating their character.
- **Attribute Spread:** DEX +2, END +1, WIL +1, WIS +1 (5 locked; distribute remaining 5) | Primary attack attribute: DEX

Level	Base DA	FP	WP	Max Tokens
1	9	9	6	12
2	9	10	6	14
3	9	12	7	16

Innate Skill (free at character creation)

Conjure [Innate]

Type: Minor Action • Attribute: DEX • Roll: None • SP Cost: Free • Token Cost: 0 Tokens

Summon a usable quantity of an available element into being (a handful of flame, a sphere of water, a clump of earth, a coil of air, a spark of lightning). The conjured element is raw material: it can be used for non-combat utility such as lighting a fire or freezing a lock so that it breaks easily. As its own action, it cannot be thrown as an attack, though once conjured a skill can utilize the available element. The specialty element chosen at creation can always be conjured from nothing; all other elements require a source nearby. This skill upgrades automatically at set level thresholds at no SP or token cost.

Starting Abilities

Your innate skill, plus 3 Level 1 skills you can buy with Skill Points (SP) at creation.

- **Bolt:** Hurl an element at a target; damage scales with how well you hit.
- **Guard:** Snap up a momentary elemental barrier as a reaction, adding +2 to your defense against one incoming attack.
- **Armament:** Shape an element into a weapon form: a fire sword, ice arrows, a lightning whip.
- **Cinder:** A close-range elemental strike that uses your DEX where others would punch.

MOVER

Potezen (Magic-Born): *Force without fire. The invisible attacks of telekinesis.*

The mover rarely fights with their hands, rarely has to get up close and personal, rarely has to get dirty. The mover fights often from a distance, using telekinesis to shift the tides of the battle and to manipulate the battlefield where they can.

Often a mover goes throughout Nesloke, beloved for their ability to help and be supportive while also managing to inspire more than cause fear. Their power is not physically seen, like that of the casters. Your typical person is not going to be intimidated by the mover, but that is where that typical person fails.

Because if they do fail to realize just how powerful the mover can be, that is when they will lose and lose fast with their sheer force of will power. They are going to control things around them with their mind and create for themselves opportunities and advantages that were not previously there.

Who will love this: the tactical, team-minded player who likes enabling others and controlling space over dealing the biggest hit.

Role at the table: battlefield control and team enablement; the one who makes everyone else's turn better.

Mechanical Identity

- **Type:** A Potezen who moves objects and people with the mind, shaping impact and pressure into directed force.
- **Attribute Spread:** WIL +2, INT +1, WIS +1, END +1 (5 locked; distribute remaining 5) |
Primary attack attribute: WIL

Level	Base DA	FP	WP	Max Tokens
1	8	10	3	12
2	8	15	3	14

Level	Base DA	FP	WP	Max Tokens
3	8	19	4	16

Innate Skill (free at character creation)

Weightless Grip **[Innate]**

Type: Core Action • Attribute: WIL • Roll: WIL DA 8 • SP Cost: Free • Token Cost: 0 Tokens

The Mover telekinetically manipulates unattended objects within Close range. A Core Action is required to move, hold, or reposition the object. No roll is required for unattended objects. The Mover may not manipulate objects being held or worn by another creature without a DA 8 WIL roll or roll against the Defensive Armor of the character holding the object. This skill upgrades automatically at set level thresholds at no SP or token cost.

Starting Abilities

Your innate skill, plus 3 Level 1 skills you can buy with Skill Points (SP) at creation.

- **Force Veil:** React to an attack on you or a nearby ally by trying to block it with a wall of force.
- **Gravity Rebuke:** Negate falling damage for yourself, and catch allies mid-fall.
- **Kinetic Surge:** Pour extra force into your next attack to amplify its damage.
- **Telekinetic Strike:** Your core attack: a focused burst of unseen force at one target, close or far.

DECEIVER

Potezen (Magic-Born): *The only mind at the table that rewrites what others believe.*

Unlike all of the other Potezen, the deceiver is not loved, is not honored, is not treated well. It's hard to be when people learn that you have the ability to alter what they see and, if you're really strong, alter what they remember.

The deceiver is just that. They are battlefield manipulation by perception and senses. Unlike the mover, they are not physically moving things around, but they are getting into the minds of their enemies and forcing them to see things that aren't there or miss things that are.

This is the class of the clever one, the careful one, the calculated one. This Potezen-born player character will often want to keep their magic to themselves, for fear they will be looked down upon. As a deceiver, it's really easy to do that because you can cause others to not even notice you.

Who will love this: the player who wants to win without swinging: intrigue, misdirection, social power, the clever way through.

Role at the table: control and social dominance; the one who bends scenes, not just fights.

Mechanical Identity

- **Type:** A Potezen who alters perception and belief through illusion and manipulation of the senses.
- **Attribute Spread:** WIL +2, END +1, INT +1, CHA +1 (5 locked; distribute remaining 5) | Primary attack attribute: WIL

Level	Base DA	FP	WP	Max Tokens
1	9	8	4	12
2	9	11	5	14
3	9	14	6	16

Innate Skill (free at character creation)

Sensory Whisper **[Innate]**

Type: Minor Action • Attribute: None • Roll: No Roll Required • SP Cost: Free • Token Cost: 0 Tokens

Project a false sensory impression onto one target within Close range. The Deceiver may affect smell, sound, taste, or touch. Sight is never affected by this skill. If a target has reason to be suspicious, they may recognize the illusion through roleplay and GM discretion, but no mechanical check resolves this. The effect lasts up to 30 seconds and ends when the Deceiver chooses or when the duration expires.

Starting Abilities

Your innate skill, plus 3 Level 1 skills you can buy with Skill Points (SP) at creation.

- **Planted Seed:** Slip a false but plausible belief into someone's mind so they act on it as their own.
- **Static:** React to an attack by flooding the attacker with false positional cues, lowering the blow.
- **False Opening:** When you are hit, turn the moment into a retaliatory illusion that sets up your next strike.
- **Hollow Face:** Alter your surface appearance enough to pass casual scrutiny.
- **Read the Room:** Always know the true emotional state of anyone you speak with, a passive social sense.

HUNTER

Non-Potezen (Skilled Specialist): *The tracker, the marksman, the ghost of the wild. And never alone.*

The hunter is a master of archery, a master of stealth, and at one with nature. Around them, they are more comfortable in the forests and in the cities. They are more comfortable around animal companions and with people, but no matter what, they are aware.

They are the trackers. They are rarely tracked. They are the ghosts who slip into the shadows, and it is hard to slip away from them. If Robin Hood were an archetype, he would have been a hunter, not just because of his strength and ability with an arrow, but because of his ability to fight and win and manage to be unseen in the process. When you choose to play a hunter, you are choosing a calculated marksman and a careful person, and within a world of Potezen powers, the hunter is able to hold their own and will not back down to anyone else.

Who will love this: the player who wants precision, independence, stealth, and a loyal companion.

Role at the table: ranged damage, scouting, tracking, and the party's non-magical backbone.

Mechanical Identity

- **Type:** A non-Potezen specialist: ranged weapon mastery, tracking, true stealth, and a bonded animal companion.
- **Attribute Spread:** WIS +2, DEX +2, END +1 (5 locked; distribute remaining 5) | Primary attack attribute: DEX

Level	Base DA	FP	WP	Max Tokens
1	9	10	8	12
2	9	14	10	14
3	9	17	12	16

Innate Skill (free at character creation)

Track [Innate]

Type: Core Action • Attribute: WIS • Roll: No Roll Required • SP Cost: Free • Token Cost: 0 Tokens

Cut and follow a trail: from physical signs (tracks, blood, disturbed ground, kill remains, dropped gear, etc.) determine that a creature or person passed through the area, how many, how recently, and which way they went, reading the terrain in service of the trail. Only what the evidence supports of the area. Never grants a mechanical bonus.

Starting Abilities

Your innate skill, plus 3 Level 1 skills you can buy with Skill Points (SP) at creation.

- **Called Shot:** Declare a precise target on a ranged shot with no penalty, for a fitting effect on a hit.
- **Unseen:** Move through or out of a scene unnoticed when the fiction allows.
- **Animal Affinity:** Non-hostile animals treat you as a friend by default.

APOTHECARY

Non-Potezen (Skilled Specialist): No magic. Just knowledge, chemistry, and the will to keep everyone standing.

Oh, the Apothecary. They don't have access to any innate magic. What did they decide to do within this world, within Nesloke? They decided to create their magic. In direct opposition to the Potezen around them, the Apothecary learns through science. Knowledge is their strength, and their ability to understand the world around them is their magic. Because of this ability to understand everything from medicines to combustible liquids, they are both your healer and your aggressive alchemist.

They are not bound by the limitations of the singular magical powers that a Potezen is bound to. Instead, their mind allows them to reach new heights. They can fight when they need to. They can hide when they need to. They can heal when they need to. They are the ultimate support and one of the deadliest attackers.

When they fight, it's often not fair because when you anger the careful, quiet, intelligent one, you learn that their arsenal is more than you can handle. The Apothecary has the unique advantage of being the only

archetype that can truly prepare for battle ahead of time, not just in equipping themselves but in equipping their allies.

Who will love this: the player who wants to support, sustain, and solve: the healer, the chemist, the prepared one who's never out of answers.

Role at the table: sustain and utility; the party's lifeline and problem-solver.

Mechanical Identity

- **Type:** A non-Potezen science specialist working through crafted compounds; healer or alchemist by choice.
- **Attribute Spread:** INT +2, WIS +2, CHA +1 (5 locked; distribute remaining 5) | Primary attack attribute: WIS

Level	Base DA	FP	WP	Max Tokens
1	9	12	8	12
2	9	15	9	14
3	9	18	10	16

Innate Skill (free at character creation)

Assess [Innate]

Type: Core Action • Attribute: WIS • Roll: None, Automatic (GM may call for WIS) • SP Cost: Free • Token Cost: 0 Tokens

Spend one minute closely examining a creature, substance, wound, or material. Learn factual information about it: what it is, what is physically wrong with it, what a substance does, whether something is safe to consume or handle. The GM answers truthfully. Grants no mechanical bonus, purely knowledge about the fiction.

Starting Abilities

Your innate skill, plus 3 Level 1 skills you can buy with Skill Points (SP) at creation.

- **Antidote:** Craft a cure that removes a poison or toxin from a target.
- **Bandage:** Your foundational heal: a bandage that restores a little stamina, no roll needed.
- **Caustic Vial:** A throwable acid attack against a single target at range.
- **Stim Shot:** Dose a creature so their next roll this round gains an edge.
- **Tourniquet:** Stop ongoing bleed and poison-tick damage without restoring stamina.

N CHARACTER CREATION

Now that you know how the game works and you've met the five archetypes, you can build your character (or choose one of the pre-generated ones). Creation moves through eight steps.

STEP 1: CONCEPT AND ARCHETYPE

Choose one of the five archetypes: Caster, Mover, Deceiver, Hunter, or Apothecary. Your archetype sets your locked attributes, your starting pools, your innate skill, and the skills you'll be able to choose from. If you're unsure, return to the archetype pages and pick the one whose fantasy pulls at you.

STEP 2: ATTRIBUTES

Your archetype locks part of your attribute spread (5 of the available 10 points) and lets you distribute the remaining points across the seven attributes (STR, DEX, END, INT, WIS, CHA, WIL), staying within a +3 ceiling and -1 floor. Each archetype page lists its locked spread and how many points you distribute. You can choose up to two attributes to assign -1 as the attribute, allowing you to use up to an additional +2 toward other attributes. The total attribute spread will equal +10.

STEP 3: BACKGROUND AND STORY

Background defines where your character came from and the habits that shape their choices. Each background grants Geld (currency), a roleplay advantage and disadvantage, and a small mechanical effect. Choose one.

Background	Geld	Advantage / Disadvantage	Effect
Wanderer	30	Adapts quickly / distrusts institutions	+1 to navigation or survival WIS checks.
Apprentice	30	Retains mentor knowledge / hesitates without instruction	Begin with +1 additional Skill Point.
Soldier	15	Works in formation / struggles with independent action	+2 Max FP.
Scholar	20	Analytical under pressure / distracted by curiosity	+1 to recall or history INT checks.
Merchant	50	Reads intentions / questions sincerity	+1 CHA to trade or persuasion checks.
Outcast	20	Moves quietly / slow to bond	+1 to stealth or evasion checks.
Laborer	25	Practical and durable / little formal education	+1 to STR-based checks.
Acolyte	20	Understands discipline / deferential to authority	+1 WP at creation.
Caretaker	10	Attentive to suffering / self-sacrificing	Recover 4 FP when tending another, once per Long Rest.

STEP 4: STARTING POOLS (TOKENS, FP, WP)

Your archetype sets your starting FP, WP, and Defensive Armor (DA). Every character at level one starts with 12 tokens and refreshes their tokens to 12 after each long rest. Your FP and WP starting values and their growth are listed on your archetype page.

STEP 5: SKILLS

You begin with your archetype's free Innate Skill. At Level 1 you receive 3 Skill Points and may buy 3 skills from your Level 1 options (each costs 1 SP). See Progression for the full skill list, costs, and a guided path if you'd like a recommended starting set.

STEP 6: STARTING EQUIPMENT

Choose one gear set to define your initial readiness. Each set remains flexible across archetypes.

Gear Set	Includes	Intended Role
Endurer	Light Armor (+1 DA), restorative items (3 bandages, 1 tonic), +15 Geld	Support, recovery, balanced endurance.
Swift	Unarmored (+0 DA), short weapon or dagger, +20 Geld	Agile or stealth-oriented play.

Nesloke-Lite includes two gear sets and two armor types. The full game adds more armor, more gear, and additional options.

STEP 7: ARMOR

Armor	DA Bonus	Effect	Drawback
Unarmored	+0	Grants +1 to all DEX rolls. Encourages mobility.	Minimal protection; vulnerable to FP and WP loss.
Light Armor	+1	Reliable protection, no penalty.	None.

STEP 8: FINAL TOUCHES

Name your character, note their appearance and manner, and record their starting values on the character sheet. You're ready to play.

The character sheet and five ready-to-play pregenerated characters are provided as a separate attachment, so your group can begin playing right away.

EQUIPMENT

Equipment defines readiness, not identity. Geld defines opportunity, not worth. One Geld equals one day of modest wage. Track your equipped items, available Geld, and key consumables.

WEAPONS

Every weapon uses an attribute (STR or DEX) and may add a hit modifier. Potezen may carry and use any weapon.

Weapon	Attribute	Hit Mod	Range	Requires	Cost	Notes
Dagger	DEX	+0	Close / Far	None	3	Light, concealable.
Bow	DEX	+1	Far	DEX +1	15	Two-handed, ranged only.
Sword	STR	+1	Close	DEX +1	10	Balanced, common.
Hand Axe	STR	+0	Close / Far	None	8	Throwable.
Spear	STR	+1 Close / +0 Far	Close / Far	None	8	Versatile.

ARMOR

Armor	DA Bonus	Notes	Cost
Unarmored	+0	+1 to DEX rolls. Fastest, least protection.	N/A
Light Armor	+1	Reliable, balanced, no penalty.	15 to 25 Geld

CONSUMABLES

Item	Action	Effect	Cost
Bandage	Core	Restore 3 FP to self or ally; stops Bleeding.	5 Geld
Tonic	Minor	Restore 5 FP or 1 WP (choose one).	10 Geld
Greater Tonic	Minor	Restore 8 FP or 2 WP (choose one).	20 Geld
Antidote	Minor	Remove Poisoned.	10 Geld
Restorative Salve	Minor	Remove Weakened or Bleeding.	15 Geld
Soothing Balm	Minor	Remove Burning or Frozen.	15 Geld
Calming Draft	Minor	Remove Panicked or Stunned.	20 Geld
Focus Draught	Minor	Restore 3 Tokens.	15 Geld
Medical Kit	Core	Restore 4 FP and 4 WP.	30 Geld

Crafting and the wider economy are part of the full game.

CONDITIONS

Conditions represent lasting effects that change how a character acts until cleared. Conditions can be cleared by treatment, rest, time, or narrative closure.

Condition	Mechanic
Bleeding	-1 FP at the start of each round until tended.
Burning	-2 FP per round until extinguished.
Frozen	Strain (-2) while frozen.
Stunned	No actions for the next round.
Blinded	Strain (-2) on attacks; cannot make non-close actions.
Bound	Cannot perform Core Actions.
Weakened	Strain (-2) on STR-based checks.
Staggered	Cannot perform Minor Actions.
Panicked	May act but cannot attack an enemy.
Inspired	Edge (+2) to all checks.

Ⓝ REST AND RECOVERY

Characters recover through rest. A Short Rest recovers half your FP and 2 Tokens; a Long Rest restores half WP, maximum FP, and maximum Tokens. Tokens return to their maximum after a Long Rest, and a Short Rest returns 2 Tokens.

Ⓝ PROGRESSION (TO LEVEL 3)

Leveling in Nesloke measures consequence, not routine. In Nesloke-Lite you grow from Level 1 to Level 3, the opening stretch of a longer climb. Advancement is by Milestone (the default, story-driven method).

Where Lite ends This guide takes you to Level 3. The full game climbs all the way to Level 12, where each archetype earns its Forged, Mark, and Mastered capstone skills. Think of Level 3 as the end of chapter one, not the end of the story. Nesloke-Lite focuses only on Milestone leveling, whereas XP leveling is included in the full game.

LEVELING PROCEDURE

When a character gains a level, apply the following, then restore all FP, WP, and Tokens to maximum before resuming play.

- **Skill Points:** gained per the ladder below and spent to purchase new skills. Once purchased, a skill is permanent.
- **FP and WP:** grow along your archetype's own curve, listed on your archetype page.
- **Tokens:** maximum pool grows +2 per level (16 at Level 3). Tokens reset to maximum after a Long Rest; a Short Rest recovers 2.

SKILL POINT ECONOMY (LEVELS 1 TO 3)

Level	SP Gained	Cumulative SP Earned
1	3	3
2	2	5
3	2	7

SKILL CATEGORIES

Category	Meaning
Base	Foundational skills; often the root of a chain. No prerequisite.
Enhanced	Upgrades that require a prerequisite Base or earlier Enhanced skill.
Forged	Complete, high-impact standalone skills; may have a prerequisite.
Mark	The only always-active passives. Everything else must be activated.
Innate	Your archetype's free starting skill, granted at character creation.

The Mastered (Crimson) capstone category exists only above Level 3 and is part of the full game.

Skill Trees

Every skill available through Level 3, in full. Your Innate Skill and its rules also appear on your archetype page; here you have the complete mechanics, gathered by archetype and level.

Caster Skill Tree

Innate Skill

Conjure [Innate]

Type: Minor Action, Elemental Summoning • Attribute: DEX • Roll: None / GM-Set DA for Difficult Forms • SP Cost: Free • Token Cost: 0 Tokens

Summon a usable quantity of an available element into being: a handful of flame, a sphere of water, a clump of earth, a coil of air, a spark of lightning. What you summon is raw material. You can shape it, hold it, or feed it into your other skills, or put it to simpler use: lighting a fire, filling a vessel, clearing debris, signaling across a distance. On its own it is not a weapon, and you cannot throw it to harm. Your chosen element

you can always call from nothing; every other element needs a source close by. This skill grows as you do, upgrading on its own at set levels.

Level 1

Bolt [Base]

Type: Core Action • Attribute: DEX • Roll: DEX vs Target's DA • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Project an available element at a target in range, damage by hit tier. The better you land it, the more it hurts. Nothing more at base, just clean, direct force.

Guard [Base]

Type: Reaction • Attribute: END • Roll: None • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

+2 DA against one incoming attack. As the attack comes, you throw up a barrier of your element in the instant you need it.

Armament [Forged]

Type: Core Action • Attribute: DEX • Roll: None • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 0 Tokens

Shape an available element into a weapon form. A fire sword, ice arrows, a rock axe, a lightning whip, an air lance, whatever the moment calls for. It fights as a normal weapon of its type, no bonus to hit or damage beyond that, and holds its form as long as you maintain it.

Cinder [Forged]

Type: Minor Action • Attribute: DEX • Roll: DEX vs Target's DA • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 0 Tokens

A close strike using DEX in place of an unarmed attack. Where someone else would throw a punch, you answer with fire, or frost, or a fistful of stone. If your element is close at hand, add +1 to the roll.

Level 2

Bastion [Forged]

Type: Core Action • Attribute: DEX • Roll: None • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

+1 DA for the entire encounter. You conjure your element into a shield you carry, and it holds as long as you maintain it, reshaping itself if it breaks.

Gust [Forged]

Type: Core Action • Attribute: DEX • Roll: DEX vs Target's DA • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Knockback, no damage. Air or water only. You shove a target or a loose object back with a sudden force, buying space or breaking a line.

Sheathe [Forged]

Type: Minor Action • Attribute: DEX • Roll: None • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Coat a held object in an available element for utility. Light a torch, burn through rope, freeze a lock brittle, charge a surface. The work you do outside a fight, done with a touch.

Level 3

Lift [Base]

Type: Core Action • Attribute: DEX • Roll: DEX vs DA 10 • SP Cost: 2 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Hover and move short distances above the ground for a few rounds. Air only. You ride the wind itself, up and over what would stop anyone else.

Shape [Base]

Type: Core Action • Attribute: DEX • Roll: DEX vs GM-Set DA for Complex Forms • SP Cost: 2 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Mold an available element into a simple functional object: an ice key, a stone wedge, an earthen cup, a frozen blade. It holds its form as long as the element persists. Given a problem, you make the tool for it.

Bulwark [Enhanced]

Type: Reaction • Attribute: END • Roll: None • SP Cost: 2 • Token Cost: 2 Tokens

+3 DA against one incoming attack. Requires Guard. The same instinct as Guard, drawn deeper: a heavier wall thrown up against a heavier hit.

Mover Skill Tree

Innate Skill

Weightless Grip [Innate]

Type: Core Action, Object Manipulation • Attribute: WIL • Roll: None (unattended) / WIL vs DA 8 (held or worn) • SP Cost: Free • Token Cost: 0 Tokens

Move, hold, or reposition an unattended object within Close range with your mind alone. Routine work on unattended objects needs no roll: you reach out, and it answers. To wrest an object held or worn by another creature, roll against the Defensive Armor of the character holding the object. This skill grows as you do, upgrading on its own at set levels.

Level 1

Force Veil [Base]

Type: Reaction, Broad Defense • Attribute: WIS vs DA 8 • Roll: DA 8 • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

When you or an ally beside you is attacked, roll WIS vs DA 8; on a success the attack is blocked or

reduced by one damage tier. You catch the force before it lands and bend it aside. On a failure the attack proceeds and the Token is lost. You cannot turn aside heavy weapons unless you have taken the Elevated version.

Gravity Rebuke [Base]

Type: Reaction, Situational Defense • Attribute: WIL vs DA 9 (allies only; automatic for self) • Roll: DA 9 for allies • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 0 Tokens

Negate fall damage. For yourself it is automatic and free: the ground never quite arrives. To catch a falling ally, spend 1 Token and roll WIL vs DA 9 for each one; on a failed roll the Token is spent and that ally falls as normal.

Kinetic Surge [Base]

Type: Minor Action, Offensive Amplifier • Attribute: WIL vs DA 8 • Roll: DA 8 • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Amplify your next attack by one damage tier on a success. Declared before your Core Action, you pour extra force behind what is already coming. If the roll fails the Token is still spent and the attack lands unamplified. Declare and resolve it before you take the Core Action.

Telekinetic Strike [Base]

Type: Core Action, Offensive Attack • Attribute: WIL vs Target's DA • Roll: Target's DA • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 0 Tokens

A focused burst of telekinetic force against one target in Close or Far range. This is your reach: no hands, no weapon, just will crossing the distance. On a Critical Hit you choose one rider: the target is knocked Prone, or their DA drops by 2 until the start of your next turn.

Level 2

Mind Shield [Base]

Type: Minor Action, Mental Defense • Attribute: END vs DA 8 (concentration each turn) • Roll: DA 8 to maintain • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

A sustained buffer granting a DA bonus against all mental and Potezen-based attacks while active.

You hold a wall around your own mind. Spend a Minor Action each turn and roll END vs DA 8 to keep it up; on a failed check it drops at once, as it does if you take a Direct or Critical Hit from any source.

Telekinetic Ward [Base]

Type: Preparation, Utility • Attribute: WIS to establish • Roll: GM-set DA by ward complexity • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Lay an invisible detection field around a location, doorway, or perimeter. When anything of note crosses it, the whole party is alerted at once, even from sleep. The GM sets the duration (up to 12 hours) and the DA by the ward's size and complexity. It is spent the moment it triggers. This is how you keep watch without ever standing guard.

Loosen [Forged]

Type: Core Action, Escape • Attribute: WIL • Roll: WIL vs DA 7 + grappler's STR modifier • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Break free of a grapple. Roll WIL vs DA 7 plus the grappler's STR modifier, the stronger they are, the harder the hold is to slip. On a success you are free; on a failure you may try again on later turns. Where another would need muscle, you need only will: the hold means nothing to a mind that refuses it.

Sweep [Forged]

Type: Core Action, Offensive Control • Attribute: WIL vs Target's DA +2 • Roll: Target's DA +2 • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Knock a target Prone. Roll WIL vs their DA +2, the higher difficulty for the precision it takes; on a Partial Hit or better they go down and must spend a Minor Action next turn to stand. You take their legs out from under them without touching them.

Surrounding Pressure [Mark]

Type: Passive, Always Active • Attribute: None • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 0 Tokens

Passive. You cannot be surprised, and you are always aware of the number, position, and

movement of creatures and significant objects within Close range, even in darkness or when you cannot see. A constant, quiet telekinetic sense holds the space around you in your mind at all times.

Level 3

Steady Guard [Base]

Type: Minor Action, Damage Mitigation • Attribute: None, No Roll Required • SP Cost: 2 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Reduce the next incoming hit on yourself or a Close ally by one damage tier, no roll. You set a buffer and hold it steady. It fades after 2 rounds if nothing strikes it or your focus breaks, and only one may be active at a time.

Telekinetic Grapple [Base]

Type: Core Action to establish / Minor Action to maintain, Control • Attribute: WIL vs Target's DA • Roll: Target's DA • SP Cost: 2 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Hold a target in place with force alone. Roll WIL vs their DA; on a Partial Hit or better they are held, and while held they take 1 stack of Strain on any Core or Minor Action they attempt. Spend a Minor Action each turn to keep the hold. It ends the moment you take a Direct or Critical Hit, or choose to let go.

Kinetic Opening [Forged]

Type: Minor Action, Proactive Support • Attribute: WIS vs DA 8 • Roll: DA 8 • SP Cost: 2 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Grant a chosen ally Edge on their next attack against a Close target this turn. Declared before their roll, you shift the ground or the air just enough to open a gap in the enemy's guard. Roll WIS vs DA 8; on a failure the Token and Minor Action are spent for nothing. Declare and resolve it before the ally rolls.

Last Push [Forged]

Type: Reaction, Reactive Salvage • Attribute: WIS vs DA 8 • Roll: DA 8 • SP Cost: 2 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Upgrade an ally's Failure or Partial Hit by one outcome tier. The instant their roll comes up

short, roll WIS vs DA 8; on a success a last touch of force nudges it up (Failure to Partial, Partial to Grazing). On a failure the Token is spent and the result stands. Close targets only.

Deceiver Skill Tree

Innate Skill

Sensory Whisper [Innate]

Type: Minor Action, Sensory Illusion • Attribute: None • Roll: No Roll Required • SP Cost: Free • Token Cost: 0 Tokens

Project a false sensory impression onto one target within Close range: smell, sound, taste, or touch, never sight. This is where you begin, slipping a small lie past someone's senses before they think to question it. If a target has reason to be suspicious they may see through it in the fiction, at the GM's call, but no roll resolves it. It lasts up to 30 seconds, ending when you choose or when the time runs out.

Level 1

Planted Seed [Base]

Type: Core Action, Social Manipulation • Attribute: INT vs GM-set DA • Roll: GM-set DA • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Plant a false but plausible belief in a target's mind during conversation. On a success they take it up as their own conclusion and act on it. You never argue them into it; you let them arrive there. The belief has to fit what they already know.

Static [Base]

Type: Reaction, Defensive Misdirection • Attribute: WIL vs DA 9 • Roll: DA 9 • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

When you are attacked, roll WIL vs DA 9 to lower the incoming attack by one tier before it resolves. You flood the attacker's eye with a wrong step, a misleading lean, a shift that was never there, and the strike arrives just slightly off.

False Opening [Forged]

Type: Reaction, Offensive Setup • Attribute: WIL vs DA 8 • Roll: DA 8 • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

When an attack lands on you, roll WIL vs DA 8; on a success you gain Edge on your next attack against that same attacker. You take the hit and turn it into an opening, letting them believe they have you a breath before you answer.

Hollow Face [Forged]

Type: Minor Action, Appearance Alteration • Attribute: CHA vs GM-set DA • Roll: GM-set DA • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Alter your surface appearance, features, hair, skin tone, the impression of your build, enough to pass casual scrutiny. It is not a true disguise. It will not fool someone who knows you well or looks closely.

Read the Room [Mark]

Type: Passive, Always Active • Attribute: None • Roll: No Roll Required • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 0 Tokens

Passive. You always know the genuine emotional state of anyone you are speaking with directly, fear, anger, guilt, grief, the lie behind the smile. This is not mind-reading. It is pattern and instinct sharpened to near-perfect accuracy, the room read before anyone knows they have shown you anything.

Level 2

Sensory Flicker [Base]

Type: Minor Action, Disruptive Illusion • Attribute: WIL vs Target's DA • Roll: Target's DA • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

On a hit, the target gains 1 stack of Strain. You flood them with a burst of contradictory input, sound from the wrong direction, a phantom touch, a smell that doesn't belong, and for a moment nothing they sense can be trusted.

The Drop [Base]

Type: Core Action, Offensive Attack • Attribute: WIL vs Target's DA • Roll: Target's DA • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

On a hit, damage is raised one tier above the standard outcome. At the moment you attack you feint, a false angle, a movement that never comes, and they commit to the wrong stance. The opening you made is where it lands.

Hollow Threat [Forged]

Type: Core Action, Disruptive Illusion • Attribute: WIL vs GM-set DA • Roll: GM-set DA • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

On a success, the target retreats to Far range if able and spends their Minor Action reacting. You raise a threat that isn't there, a lifted weapon, a figure lunging from a blind spot, and they answer the danger you invented instead of the one in front of them.

Shadow Step [Forged]

Type: Minor Action, Defensive Concealment • Attribute: WIL vs DA 8 • Roll: DA 8 • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 2 Tokens

On a success, you vanish and leave a still image of yourself where you stood; enemies keep attacking it, believing it is you. The image holds until it is struck or until you take an offensive action. You are simply no longer where they are looking.

The Unseen Hand [Forged]

Type: Minor Action, Utility Misdirection • Attribute: DEX vs GM-set DA • Roll: GM-set DA • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 0 Tokens

On a success, you complete a hand action, pickpocketing, sleight of hand, any quiet manipulation, without it being noticed, because your hand appears to be somewhere it is not. On a failure the action simply doesn't come off; there is no worse consequence than that.

Level 3

Convincing Exit [Forged]

Type: Core Action, Social Concealment • Attribute: CHA vs GM-set DA • Roll: GM-set DA • SP Cost: 2 • Token Cost: 1 Token

On a success, everyone present becomes certain you have already left, or were never there at all,

with no memory of your presence or your leaving. Non-combat only. They do not see you sneak out. You have convinced the room you were already gone.

The Badge [Forged]

Type: Minor Action, Credential Fabrication • Attribute: INT vs GM-set DA • Roll: GM-set DA • SP Cost: 2 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Make an object you are carrying appear to be whatever credential, seal, writ, or document the moment demands. You must know what the real thing looks like. The illusion covers appearance only and will not survive close physical examination, so you carry it with the confidence of someone who belongs.

Still Waters [Mark]

Type: Passive, Always Active (Toggleable) • Attribute: None • Roll: No Roll Required • SP Cost: 2 • Token Cost: 0 Tokens

Passive, toggleable at will with no action cost. You can make your face completely still at any moment, no readable expression, no tell, no visible lip movement even as you speak. Nothing crosses your face that you do not put there.

Hunter Skill Tree

Innate Skill

Track [Innate]

Type: Core Action, Pursuit • Attribute: WIS • Roll: None (information only) • SP Cost: Free • Token Cost: 0 Tokens

Cut and follow a trail from physical sign: tracks, blood, disturbed ground, scat, kill remains, dropped gear. You learn that a creature or person passed, how many, how recently, and which way they went, reading the terrain in service of the trail. You find only what the evidence supports, no more. It only tells you the truth of what is in front of you that others often miss.

Level 1

Called Shot [Base]

Type: Core Action • Attribute: DEX • Roll: On your attack roll • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Declare a specific spot on a ranged or thrown attack, Close or Far, with no penalty. On a hit, the GM may apply a fitting condition if the fiction supports it: a leg shot slows, a hand shot drops what they hold, an eye shot blinds for a moment. You do not just hit them. You hit exactly where you meant to.

Unseen [Base]

Type: Core Action • Attribute: DEX • Roll: DEX vs GM-set DA (with Edge) • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 0 Tokens

Move through or out of a scene unnoticed when the fiction allows, rolling with Edge. This is the Hunter's sharper version of the move anyone can attempt. No grid, no line of sight to track, just you, gone from where they were watching.

Animal Affinity [Mark]

Type: Always Active • Attribute: WIS • Roll: None (Edge when a roll is called) • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 0 Tokens

Passive. Non-hostile animals treat you as friendly by default. You may calm, read, or influence them through roleplay with no Token, and with Edge on any roll called for. This is the great-with-animals identity, and it needs no companion to be true: the wild simply sees you as friendly.

Level 2

Bond [Base]

Type: Core Action (downtime) • Attribute: WIS • Roll: None • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 0 Tokens

Gain one animal companion: Dog, Cat, Boar, or Rat. It has no stat block, follows you for free, and takes no meaningful action on its own without a command. This is the beginning of the companion line, the animal that is yours. If it is lost or dismissed, bond a new one over a Long Rest.

Companion Command [Base]

Type: Minor Action • Attribute: WIS • Roll: On the relevant action roll • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Send your companion to take one universal action in your place: Help Ally, Grapple, Observe, Forage, Push/Pull, Pathfind, or Sense Motive. It resolves on the relevant roll where one applies. Where you cannot be, your companion goes. Requires Bond.

Steady Draw [Base]

Type: Minor Action • Attribute: DEX • Roll: On your following attack roll • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Take aim before a ranged attack; on a hit it lands one tier higher (added, not a floor). You slow down for a breath and let the shot be right. It rides your following attack roll.

Vanish [Base]

Type: Core Action • Attribute: DEX • Roll: DEX vs GM-set DA when challenged • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

If the scene plausibly allows concealment, disappear from view; you cannot be targeted until your next turn. When something actively challenges the concealment, roll DEX vs a GM-set DA. This is your signature in a fight: one moment a target, the next nowhere to be found.

Wild Word [Base]

Type: Minor Action • Attribute: WIS • Roll: WIS vs GM-set DA • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Direct a nearby animal that is not your companion to take one simple non-attack action: move, flee, distract, carry, retrieve, reposition. You cannot command it to attack. A wild creature is not yours, but for a moment it listens, the bridge between simply handling animals and truly bonding one.

Level 3

Cripple [Enhanced]

Type: Core Action • Attribute: DEX • Roll: On your attack roll • SP Cost: 2 • Token Cost: 1 Token

A Called Shot locked to movement: on a hit, the target is slowed or hobbled, and it lasts as a standing condition rather than fading at end of turn. This is the shot you take when you need

them to stay where they are. Requires Called Shot.

Long Shot [Mark]

Type: Always Active • Roll: None • SP Cost: 2 • Token Cost: 0 Tokens

Passive. Your ranged attacks can reach targets In the Distance, not only Close and Far. One reach, covering every ranged weapon you carry. Where the range ends for everyone else, it does not end for you.

Apothecary Skill Tree

Innate Skill

Assess [Innate]

Type: Core Action, Examination • Attribute: WIS • Roll: None, Automatic (GM may call for WIS) • SP Cost: Free • Token Cost: 0 Tokens

Spend one minute closely examining a creature, substance, wound, or material, and learn the truth of it: what it is, what is wrong with it, what a substance does, whether it is safe to touch or take. The GM answers honestly. It grants no bonus, only knowledge, but knowledge is the whole of your craft. Where a Potezen reaches for power, you reach for understanding.

Level 1

Antidote [Base]

Type: Action, Cure • Attribute: INT • Roll: None, No Roll Required • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Create a consumable that removes one active poison or toxin from a creature. Pre-crafted, you can hand it to an ally to use; made on the spot, only you can apply it. The cure for what is killing them, mixed by your own hand.

Bandage [Base]

Type: Action (live) / Minor Action (pre-crafted), Applied Healing • Attribute: WIS • Roll: None pre-crafted / WIS vs DA 8 (live) • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Your foundational heal. Pre-crafted it restores 1 FP with no roll and can be handed to an ally.

When made in combat or a moment of immediacy, in your experienced hands it will either do far more than normal or cost you for fumbling:

Pre-crafted: restore 1 FP, no roll, transferable, applied as a Minor Action.

Live (you only), WIS vs DA 8:

Failure (miss by 3+): nothing; you lose 2 FP.

Partial: you lose 1 FP; target +1 FP.

Grazing: target +2 FP.

Direct: target +4 FP.

Critical: target +6 FP and +1 WP.

Caustic Vial [Base]

Type: Action, Thrown Attack • Attribute: WIS • Roll: WIS vs Target DA • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Throw an acid vial at one target within Far range as an attack. Pre-crafted, an ally can throw it for you; made live, only you can. The timing never changes what it does, only who can throw it, the roll carries everything else. Proof that the one who keeps you alive can also end you.

Stim Shot [Forged]

Type: Action, Applied Buff • Attribute: STR • Roll: None, No Roll Required • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Apply a stimulant to a creature; their next roll this round is taken with Edge (does not stack past the Edge cap). A shot to steady the hand and sharpen the moment, given right when it counts.

Tourniquet [Forged]

Type: Action, Damage Control • Attribute: WIS • Roll: None, No Roll Required • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Stop ongoing FP-over-time on a creature, bleeds, poison ticks, without restoring any FP. You are not healing the wound. You are stopping it from taking anything more.

Level 2

Pick-Me-Up [Base]

Type: Action, Exhaustion Control • Attribute: INT • Roll: None, No Roll Required • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

For a creature at 0 FP: hold off the 0-FP Strain for 3 rounds. They stay at 0 FP but stop gaining the +1 Strain each turn, so instead of spiralling to -6 across three rounds, they hold steady. It restores no FP. It buys them time, which is sometimes the only thing worth buying. Pre-crafted transferable.

Smoke Vial [Base]

Type: Action, Thrown Control • Attribute: WIS • Roll: None, No Roll Required • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Throw to raise a cloud of obscuring smoke; creatures inside take Strain on attack rolls until it clears after 2 rounds. No damage, just chaos, and cover for whoever needs it.

Salve [Enhanced]

Type: Action (live) / Minor Action (pre-crafted), Applied Healing • Attribute: WIS • Roll: None pre-crafted / WIS vs DA 8 (live) • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Your second tier of healing. Pre-crafted restores 2 FP with no roll and is transferable. Live, WIS vs DA 8, it adds +2 on the healing scale, a deeper mend from the same steady hands. Requires Bandage.

Smelling Salts [Forged]

Type: Action, Strain Relief • Attribute: WIS • Roll: None, No Roll Required • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Remove one stack of Strain from a creature that is at 0 FP or exhausted. A sharp, waking jolt that pulls someone back from the edge of collapse.

Vertigo Draught [Forged]

Type: Action, Thrown Control • Attribute: INT • Roll: WIS vs Target DA • SP Cost: 1 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Coat an area within Close range; creatures entering or acting there turn dizzy, taking Strain on physical actions until it clears. You do not stop them. You just make every move they attempt betray them.

Level 3

Adrenal Mist [Base]

Type: Action, Aerosol Support • Attribute: WIS • Roll: None, No Roll Required • SP Cost: 2 • Token Cost: 2 Tokens

Release an aerosol that restores 1 FP to every ally within narrative range at once. One breath for the whole line, given when everyone is running empty together.

Protective Salve [Base]

Type: Action (live) / Minor Action (pre-crafted), Applied Defense • Attribute: INT • Roll: None, No Roll Required • SP Cost: 2 • Token Cost: 1 Token

Apply to a creature; they gain +2 effective DA against the next attack that hits them this round. Pre-crafted transferable. Protection you prepare before you ever know where it will be needed.

Balm [Enhanced]

Type: Action (live) / Minor Action (pre-crafted), Applied Healing • Attribute: WIS • Roll: None pre-crafted / WIS vs DA 8 (live) • SP Cost: 2 • Token Cost: 2 Tokens

Your third and deepest tier of healing. Pre-crafted restores 4 FP with no roll and is transferable. Live, WIS vs DA 8, it adds +4 on the healing scale. When someone is close to gone, this is what you reach for. Requires Salve.

Grenade [Enhanced]

Type: Action, Thrown AOE Attack • Attribute: WIS • Roll: WIS vs Target DA • SP Cost: 2 • Token Cost: 2 Tokens

Throw at one target (the attack roll is against them); everyone within narrative adjacency, roughly 5 feet, is caught for FP damage as well. Aimed at a grapple, it catches both. Close range does not mean bunched, the GM and players settle who is clustered. Pre-crafted an ally can throw it; live is yours only. When the careful, quiet one finally throws something back, it is more than they can handle. Requires Caustic Vial.

Bedside Manner [Forged]

Type: Short Rest Action, Sacrificial Healing • Attribute: CHA • Roll: None, No Roll Required • SP Cost: 2 • Token Cost: 2 Tokens

During a Short Rest, give up your own recovery to tend an ally, restoring 6 FP to them (plus 2 more for every level you gain beyond the one where you took this skill). Rest only, never in combat. You go without so that they don't have to.

N Universal Skills

These skills belong to no archetype. Any character may buy them with Skill Points, the same way you buy your archetype's skills, and they are how you reach a little past what you were born or trained to be. A caster who wants to take a hit for a friend, a hunter who wants to rally the party, a deceiver who wants to cleave through two enemies at once, this is where they find it.

Level 1

Wrench [Forged]

Type: Core Action • Attribute: STR vs GM-set DA • SP 1 • 1 Token

Exert raw physical force beyond normal limits on the world around you: bend iron bars, force a sealed door, break restraints, lift collapsed debris, snap a chain. The GM sets the difficulty by what you are trying to move or break. This is force against objects, not people.

Precision Read [Forged]

Type: Core Action • Attribute: INT vs Target's DA • SP 1 • 1 Token

+1 FP damage on every successful hit, above the standard tiers. You read your opponent as you strike, finding the vulnerability and taking it in the same motion. For the character who fights with their mind as much as their hand.

Punish [Forged]

Type: Reaction • Attribute: DEX vs Target's DA • SP 1 • 1 Token

When an attacker rolls a Partial Hit or worse against you, answer immediately with a counter. Their overextension is your opening. A controlled

attack (Grazing or better) leaves no such gap, and this does not trigger.

Step In [Forged]

Type: Reaction · Attribute: END · Roll: vs DA 10 · SP 1 · 1 Token

When an ally within Close range is hit, throw yourself into the path and take it instead, one tier lighter. On a success you absorb the worst of it for them. On a failure the ally takes the hit as it came, and the cost falls on you. This is what you buy when you would rather bleed than watch someone else do it.

Rally [Forged]

Type: Minor Action · Attribute: WIS · Roll: None · SP 1 · 1 Token

Restore 2 FP to an ally, no roll. A word at the right moment, pushing them through their exhaustion. This is grit, not medicine, you are not closing wounds, you are helping them find the will to keep standing.

Brace and Shift [Forged]

Type: Minor Action · Attribute: WIL · Roll: vs DA 10 · SP 1 · 0 Tokens

On your turn, use a Minor Action to brace. If you are successfully hit before your next turn, roll, downgrade it one severity tier on a success. Where a Reaction waits to see the strike, you read it coming and set yourself against it early. On a failure you take the hit and the cost of misjudging it. This protects you alone.

On My Mark [Forged]

Type: Minor Action · Attribute: CHA · Roll: None · SP 1 · 2 Tokens

Grant one ally within Close range an extra Minor Action on their next turn, no roll. Your timing and command give them a beat they would not otherwise have had. An extra action is a rare and powerful thing, and it is priced to match.

Level 2

Open Lane [Forged]

Type: Core Action (+ Minor) · Attribute: DEX vs Target's DA · SP 1 · 1 Token

Declared alongside a melee attack: on a success, your aggression opens the target's guard, and up to two allies within Close range who still have a melee attack this turn may strike that same target with Edge. One roll governs both your attack and the opening. Your allies must act before the target's next turn to use it.

Iron Presence [Forged]

Type: Minor Action · Attribute: END · Roll: vs DA 9 · SP 1 · 1 Token

On a success, allies within Close range gain +1 to all END rolls for two rounds. Your refusal to break steadies the people around you. You must be above half FP to call on this, when you are most spent, you have nothing left to lend.

All Eyes [Forged]

Type: Minor Action · Attribute: CHA · Roll: vs DA 10 · SP 1 · 1 Token

On a success, every enemy must target you on their next turn, wherever they stand. You make yourself the only thing on the battlefield worth striking. It is a gift to your allies and a danger to you, buying them a turn while every blow comes your way.

Once More [Forged]

Type: Reaction · Attribute: WIL vs Target's DA · SP 1 · 1 Token

When you miss or land only a Partial Hit, strike again immediately using WIL in place of your usual attribute. The new result stands, better or worse, this is not a safer second try, it is a defiant one. Your refusal to accept the miss is the whole of it.

Dig In [Forged]

Type: Minor Action · Attribute: STR · Roll: vs DA 9 · SP 1 · 2 Tokens

On a success, reduce all incoming FP damage by your STR modifier for the rest of the round, every

hit, not just the next. You plant yourself and take what comes. This ends at once if you are knocked prone or grappled, footing is everything to it.

Tell [Forged]

Type: Minor Action · Attribute: WIS · Roll: vs DA 10 · SP 1 · 1 Token

On a success, an enemy within Close range gains 1 stack of Strain on their next roll. You catch the flicker of what they mean to do and throw their timing off. Worth the most against an enemy already straining under other pressure.

Level 3

Cleave [Forged]

Type: Core Action · Attribute: STR vs Target's DA · SP 2 · 0 Tokens

Catch two enemies within Close range in one sweeping strike. A single roll, and the hit tier's damage is halved and dealt to both; on a Critical Hit, both also lose 1 WP. The value is reach and economy, not raw force, you trade full damage for hitting two at once.

Blindside [Forged]

Type: Core Action · Attribute: DEX vs Target's DA · SP 2 · 1 Token

Strike from an angle they were not guarding. This attack ignores any skill-, positioning-, or Edge-based defensive bonus the target has (armor still counts, you cannot blindside plate), and on a Grazing Hit or better it leaves them with 1 stack of Strain.

Weak Point [Forged]

Type: Minor Action · Attribute: INT · Roll: vs DA 11 · SP 2 · 2 Tokens

On a success, you call out an enemy's vulnerability to the whole party, and for the next two rounds every ally deals +1 FP on each hit against that target. You are not doing the damage, you are pointing to where it lands, and anyone who heard you can use it. Best against a durable enemy who

will be struck many times before those two rounds are out.

Careful Observation [Forged]

Type: Minor Action · Attribute: WIS · Roll: Optional (see below) · SP 2 · 1 Token or 0 (see below)

Read a place or situation with piercing awareness and it gives up what it was hiding: a hidden dynamic, an intent, a danger, at the GM's call, and any traps in the immediate area are laid bare to you, disarm method included (though seeing how is not the same as being able to). You choose how to do it: spend 1 Token for an automatic success, or roll WIS vs DA 11 for free. Certainty or risk, your call.

Misdirect [Forged]

Type: Minor Action · Attribute: CHA · Roll: vs DA 11 · SP 2 · 1 Token

On a success, force one enemy within Close or Far range to send their next attack at a target you name, yourself or an ally. A word, a gesture, a lie about where the real threat is. It cannot touch a target caught in a grapple, someone locked in that struggle is past listening.

Ⓝ READY TO PLAY

Take your character to your GM and play through the Nesloke-Lite mini-campaign in the companion GM's Guide.

If the game within this book interests you and you want to continue on this journey and play the characters out to their complete extent, or get to know the other 7 archetypes, the book will be available soon in its entirety. Kickstarter launches in Fall 2026

<https://www.kickstarter.com/projects/kevtyler/nesloke-ttrpg>